

START-UPS' EXPECTATIONS FROM B-SCHOOL GRADS



ENTREPRENEURIAL MINDSET

Start-ups seek graduates who can innovate and adapt quickly to change



PROBLEM-SOLVING

Graduates are expected to solve problems with a structured and strategic approach



LEADERSHIP AND INNOVATION

Start-ups value B-school graduates for their leadership potential and ability to drive innovation



NETWORKING ADVANTAGE

Strong networks help start-ups scale through partnerships and talent acquisition



OWNERSHIP AND PROACTIVITY

Start-ups prefer graduates who show high ownership and take initiative

and approach problems creatively, offering solutions that can disrupt the status quo.

Sahil Mathur, CHRO at InMobi Group, an Indian multinational tech company, emphasises that B-school hires complement the fast-moving, agile culture of start-ups. "They're trained to approach problems with a structured mindset, complementing the agility and speed of start-ups," he says. Mathur adds that their leadership potential and contemporary business knowledge often serve as catalysts for innovation. This combination of skills and mindset is precisely what start-ups need to drive transforma-

tive growth and stay competitive in a disruptive market.

While there is no set mandate for start-ups to hire exclusively from the top B-schools, targeting these institutions has become a strategic move for many. Ashish Kumar Singh, CHRO at Meesho, a social e-commerce platform, explains that hiring from top-tier B-schools is central to their recruitment strategy. "We have primarily focussed our hiring efforts on the Top 10 B-schools in the country. We believe that recruiting from these institutions is essential to bringing the best talent on board, helping us advance Meesho's mission of

democratising internet commerce for everyone," he says.

Start-ups are actively recruiting B-school graduates across a wide range of functions, including analytics, technology, business, finance, product design, and customer experience. Plus, leadership roles are increasingly being filled by B-school alumni.

One of the unique advantages these graduates bring is their expansive professional network. Varun Gupta, Co-founder of consumer electronics brand Boulton, underscores how this network has helped his company scale and form key partnerships. "We are a young company and driven by innovation. Their fresh perspectives help us think of solutions that aren't traditional," he says.

Similarly, Amit Gupta, Co-founder of electric mobility firm Yulu, says B-school graduates not only possess strategic thinking skills but also demonstrate a strong bias for action and high ownership of their work. "They have usually dealt with diverse business scenarios and worked in fast-evolving environments. They also have the advantage of a good network of alumni, professors, and mentors, who can be beneficial for the business in building partnerships and hiring exceptional talent," he says.

STRIKING A BALANCE

While B-school graduates are highly valued, it is equally important to recognise the role of experienced industry professionals. Rupini Raman, Head of HR at Yulu, stresses the importance of finding a balance between industry professionals and B-school graduates. "Let's face it. The kind of attrition we see with these MBA grads is way higher because they